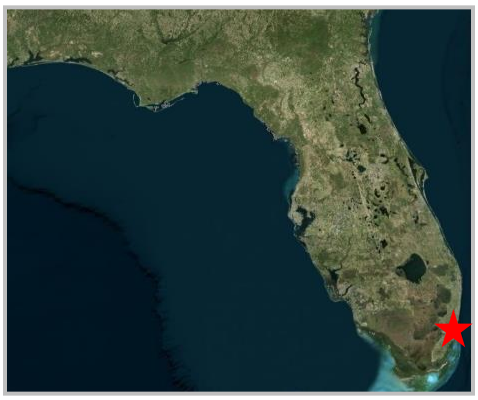
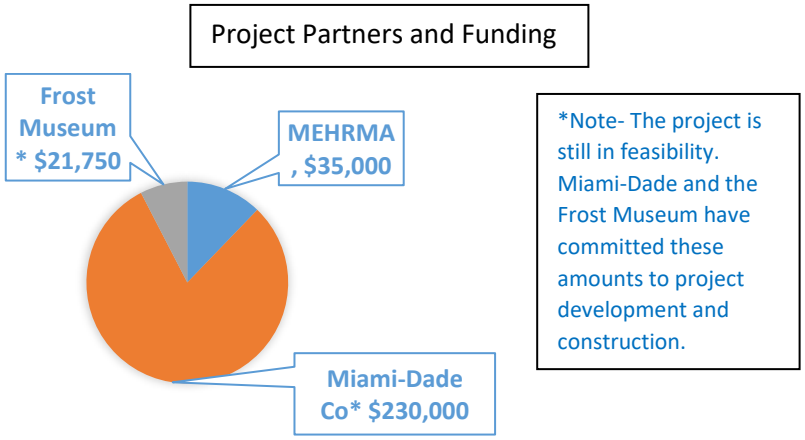
East Greynolds Park Coastal Wetlands Restoration and Enhancement

FY 17/18





Project Description

East Greynolds Park is a Miami-Dade County park located in North Miami Beach. The park encompasses 43 acres, of which, approximately 33.4 acres are managed by the Miami-Dade Environmentally Endangered Lands Program (EEL). East Greynolds Park is located along the Oleta River Corridor and is situated on the western bank of Maule Lake – an old rock mining pit that is tidally connected to Biscayne Bay and Dumbfoundling Bay. The park contains a variety of habitats, which include subtropical hardwood hammock, mangrove wetlands, and exotic dominated upland and transitional wetland communities.



Figure 1: Prior to exotic plant removal, the wetlands were dominated by woody non-native species intermixed with desirable native wetland species (e.g. mangroves). March 24, 2017.

The overall goal of this project was to remove exotic vegetation and restore appropriate wetland elevations. The project focused on an area of approximately 8.55 acres of red mangrove and transitional coastal wetland habitats located along the east and northeast portions of the park. The subject areas are dominated by non-native and invasive plants, such as Australian pine and Brazilian pepper, which have proliferated in disturbed areas where the placement of excess fill has altered historic wetland elevations and native soils. Restoration of these habitats improves both habitat and water quality within the Oleta River Corridor and Biscayne Bay, as well as providing critical coastal resilience to sea level rise along the densely urban landscape of southeast Florida.

MEHRMA funding was used to successfully hand-treat and remove exotic vegetation within 5.11 acres of East Greynold's Park in areas inaccessible to heavy equipment. A topographic survey was planned for inclusion in MEHRMA funded work; however, In September 2017, this site was greatly impacted by Hurricane Irma. Due to downed trees and excessive debris washed into the wetland, the timeline and cost of the project increased, and the topographic survey was not able to be completed. Remaining components of this project, including the topographic survey, additional clearing and grubbing of dense stands of exotic vegetation, excavation and removal of excess fill to

reach a target wetland elevation of +1.0 NGVD and planting of approximately 18,000 red mangroves and other native wetland plants, will take place through partner contributions in the coming years.

Benefits

- Removal of woody exotic plants has made it possible to conduct a topographic survey, necessary for restoring mangrove habitat
- Increased resilience to the effects of sea level rise to natural communities

FWC Strategic Plan Elements Supported

Theme1, Goal 2: Ensure sufficient habitat exists to support healthy and diverse fish and wildlife populations of all fish and wildlife.

Strategies:

- Protect lands and waters critical to sustaining healthy and diverse fish and wildlife populations through diverse incentive programs.
- Manage habitats to sustain healthy and diverse fish and wildlife populations.

Acreage restored by habitat type (footprint)

Total footprint- 5.11 acres of mangrove wetland

Acreage affected by restoration activities:

Total project area to benefit from this project and future project implementation 8.55 acres



Figure 2: Woody exotics had to be chopped and removed from the site, contributing to the costliness of this project.



Figure 3: Exotic plant removal was delayed and complicated by Hurricane Irma in September 2017. Photo shows debris washed into the project area prior to exotic removal.